National Means-cum-Merit-Scholarship Scheme

Frequently Asked Questions:

1. **What is the objective of the scheme?**

The primary objective is to support talented students from low-income families so that financial constraints do not force them to discontinue education after Class VIII.

2. **How many scholarships are awarded under scheme each year?**

Approximately 1 lakh fresh scholarships are awarded every year to selected students of Class IX.

3. **What is the scholarship amount under scheme?**

Each selected student receives ₹12,000 per annum (₹1,000 per month).

4. **Who is eligible to apply for the scholarship?**

Students whose parental income from all sources does not exceed ₹3.50 lakh per annum are eligible, subject to fulfillment of other conditions.

5. **What is the minimum academic requirement for eligibility?**

Students must have scored at least 55% marks in Class VII (relaxable by 5% for SC/ST students) to appear in the selection test.

6. **Which students are eligible in terms of school type?**

Students studying as regular students in Government, Government-aided, and Local Body schools are eligible.

7. **Are students from Kendriya Vidyalayas and Navodaya Vidyalayas eligible?**

No. Students studying in KVS, NVS, and residential schools are not eligible under scheme.

8. **Is reservation applicable under the scheme?**

Yes, reservation is applicable as per State Government norms.

9. **At which stage is the selection test conducted?**

The selection test is conducted at the Class VIII stage.

10. **What are the components of the scheme selection test?**

The test consists of two parts:

- Mental Ability Test (MAT)
- Scholastic Aptitude Test (SAT)

11. **What are the qualifying marks in the selection test?**

Students must score at least 40% marks in aggregate in MAT and SAT.

For SC/ST students, the qualifying mark is 32%.

12. When does a student start receiving the scholarship?

Selected students start receiving the scholarship from Class IX.

13. Can the scholarship be renewed in higher classes?

Yes, the scholarship is renewable in Classes X, XI, and XII, subject to fulfillment of renewal conditions.

14. Is renewal allowed if a student fails or repeats a class?

No. The scholarship is continued only if the student is promoted in the first attempt.

15. How is the scholarship disbursed to students?

The scholarship amount is transferred directly into the student’s bank account through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).